

Zed Poirier

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Kitchener, Ontario, Canada

SUMMARY



Senior VFX Artist and **Technical Art Specialist** with deep experience in real-time visual effects, shader systems, and performant cross-platform rendering. Proven track record delivering gameplay-driven VFX across VR, PC, and mobile. Experienced mentor and educator with a passion for pushing the boundaries of real-time rendering while keeping visual systems production-ready and performance-conscious.

- Gameplay-Focused VFX
- Shader Wizardry
- Baked Simulation Pipelines
- VR & Mobile Performance
- Mentorship & Teaching
- Fluent in English & French

SKILLS



Languages & Engines:	Unity, UE5, Godot, HLSL, GLSL, C++, C#, Python
VFX & Shader Tools:	Shader Graph, VFX Graph, Niagara, Material Editor, Bakery
DCC & Simulations:	Blender, Maya, 3DS MAX, Houdini, Substance Suite, Adobe Suite
Production:	Jira, Google Suite, OBS, Trello, GitHub, SVN, Google Drive

EXPERIENCE



Technical Artist - June 2024 – January 2026
Cloudhead Games — Remote Contract

- Authored real-time shaders and gameplay-driven VFX for immersive VR, improving player feedback, combat readability, and visual impact across highly interactive systems.
- Coordinated with engineering to align VFX execution across game states including dissolve shaders, material swaps, and timed particle sequences tied to enemy respawn logic.
- Adapted VFX workflows continuously to evolving production constraints and cross-discipline needs within a major VR studio pipeline.

Professor (Contract) - September 2022 – June 2024
Conestoga College — Kitchener, ON

- Taught game design and real-time VFX courses to post-secondary students across multiple 15-week course cycles.
- Mentored students on technical art pipelines, shader development, and career preparation for the competitive games industry.

Technical Artist - July 2021 – July 2024
Boss Music Games — Remote Contract

- Designed and implemented stylized gameplay VFX to strengthen combat readability, impact timing, and player responsiveness while maintaining performance budgets on Quest hardware.
- Partnered closely with design and art stakeholders to solve visual clarity challenges, delivering budget-conscious solutions without compromising style or runtime performance.

MORE EXPERIENCE



Technical Artist - May 2021 – August 2023

Shine Spark Entertainment — Remote Contract

- Developed a custom toon lighting system using Unity render pipeline features to support stylized visual direction while maintaining flexibility for gameplay needs.
- Integrated art assets, shaders, and lighting workflows to build visually cohesive environments, improving scene readability and overall production efficiency.

Shader Artist - March 2021 – August 2021

Seasonspree (Kitewing Studio) — Remote Contract

- Designed and implemented custom stylized shaders in Unity, including an ice surface shader and a procedural grass painting system.
- Built in-engine tools for artists to modify and extend existing assets, and authored ambient VFX to enhance world atmosphere.

Technical Artist - June 2020 – April 2021

BattleGoat Studios — Ancaster, ON

- Authored a 4D noise-based shader to animate seamless star surfaces for celestial bodies in Galactic Ruler, a sci-fi RTS title.
- Implemented C++ VFX triggers in a custom game engine, and researched art pipeline integration workflows for engine-native asset production.

3D Digital Artist - April 2019 – April 2020

VARLab, Conestoga College — Kitchener, ON

- Developed and integrated digital assets for VR training simulations, customising demos for international industry clients.
- Researched techniques to improve asset creation efficiency and real-time performance.

EDUCATION



- **CS50x Certificate, 2020**, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
- **Game Design Diploma, 2020**, Conestoga College, Kitchener, ON

EXTRAS



- **Game Jams:** Passionate about games as an art form and occasionally takes part in game jams and personal projects as an outlet to explore creative new shader and VFX techniques outside of production constraints. See [Sheep Tricks](#) for a recent example of a micro narrative game project.
- **TTRPGs:** Player and Dungeon Master with years of experience planning content for and running games like Dungeons and Dragon, Blades in the Dark, and Savage Worlds.
- **Game Dev Events:** Active participant in the local Kitchener and Toronto game development communities, attending events such as Dirty Rectangles and Toronto Games Week regularly.